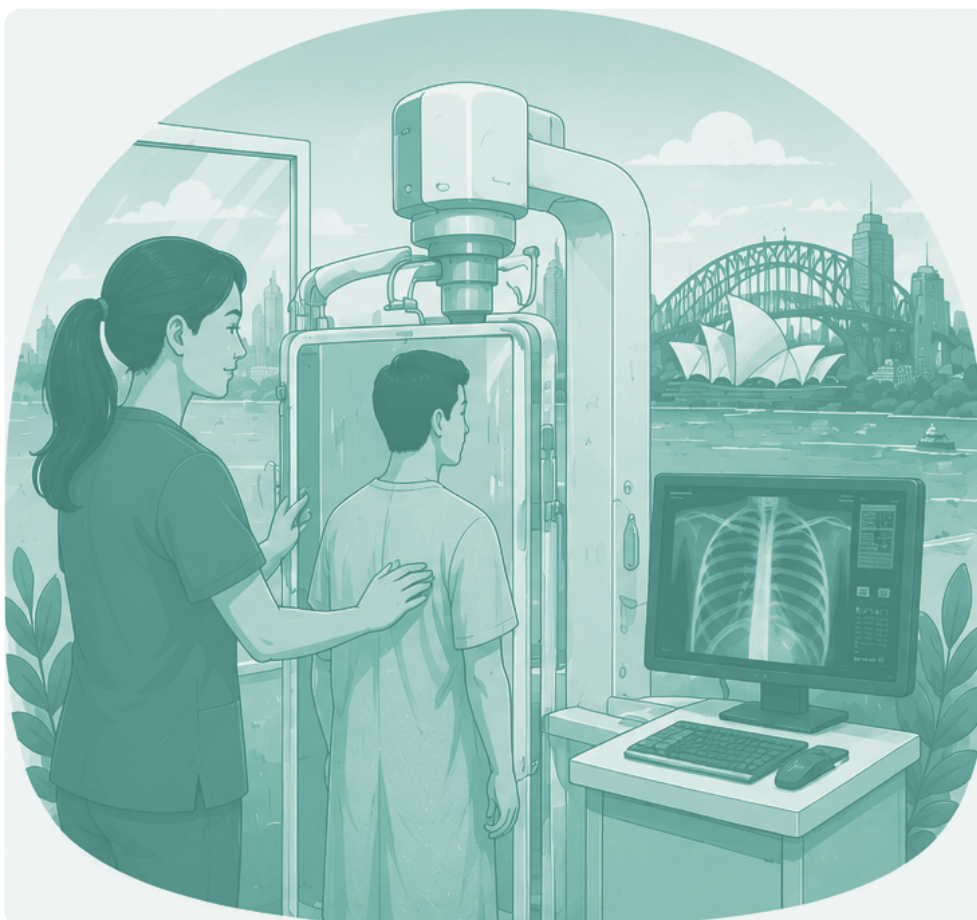


AUSTRALIA RESOURCE CENTRE

Diagnostic Radiographer Registration Guide

Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia

Your complete guide to registering as a diagnostic radiographer in Australia.



Welcome to your registration guide

Thinking about moving to Australia as a diagnostic radiographer? This guide walks you through registration with the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia (MRPBA) — the step that lets you practise here — and clears up the one thing that trips most people up.

That thing is the difference between **professional registration** and a **migration skills assessment**. They sound alike, but they're run by different bodies for different reasons — and you may not need both. We explain it plainly in Section 01, because getting it straight early saves you time and money.

Everything here comes from helping internationally qualified people make this move. We've kept it to what actually matters: getting your qualification assessed by the right body, having your paperwork ready, and knowing whether a step like the National exam applies to you.

How to use this guide

Read it through once to get the lie of the land, then keep it handy and come back to each section as you reach it. It's a handbook, not a leaflet.

An important note

This guide complements the official guidance from the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia and Ahpra — it doesn't replace it. The Board sets the standards and makes every registration decision, so where anything here differs from its published requirements, the Board's guidance wins. We support and guide you through the process, and help you secure the role and sponsorship to get here — but the registration decision is always the Board's.

What's inside

- **01** Understanding the two separate processes
- **02** The MRPBA & what it does
- **03** Is my qualification recognised?
- **04** Assessment of your qualification
- **05** The National MRP examination
- **06** English language requirements
- **07** Your supporting documents
 - ✓ Before you apply
- **08** The employer-sponsored (482) pathway
- **09** Applying & what happens next
- **10** Your registration journey
- **11** Common mistakes to avoid
- **12** Frequently asked questions

A quick word before you start

If you remember one thing from this guide, make it this: **registration and migration are two separate processes**. Section 01 explains why — and why getting them in the right order saves time, money and confusion.

Understanding the two separate processes

This is the most important section in the guide. International candidates routinely conflate two completely separate assessments — so before anything else, here's the distinction in plain terms.

1. Professional registration

Professional registration is what lets you **legally practise** as a medical radiation practitioner in Australia. It is regulated by **Ahpra** (the Australian Health Practitioner Regulation Agency) and the **Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia (MRPBA)**. The MRPBA assesses whether you meet the registration standards required to practise. **Without MRPBA registration, you cannot legally work in Australia as a radiographer** — whatever your visa says.

2. Migration skills assessment

A migration skills assessment is something else entirely. It is required for **certain skilled-migration visa pathways** and is carried out by an approved assessing authority — for diagnostic radiographers, that's **ASMIRT** (the Australian Society of Medical Imaging and Radiation Therapy). Its purpose is to assess your qualifications and experience for **immigration** purposes, not professional registration.

The key point

A positive migration skills assessment does **not** grant professional registration. And professional registration does **not** by itself satisfy migration requirements. They are separate tracks, run by different bodies, for different purposes — and you may need one, the other, or both depending on your visa.

Because the bodies assess different things, the outcomes can differ: the MRPBA can consider only your **formal qualifications** when assessing registration, while ASMIRT can also weigh your **work experience** for migration. That's why some people are approved for skilled migration yet still need to meet the Board's registration requirements.

The MRPBA & what it does

Since this guide is about practising in Australia, the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia is the body that matters most to you. Here's its role and the shape of what it assesses.

The MRPBA operates within the National Registration and Accreditation Scheme, administered by Ahpra. Its job is to protect the public by ensuring every medical radiation practitioner is suitably qualified and safe to practise. Medical radiation practice is a **protected profession**: you must be registered to use the title and to work in the role.

Three divisions, registered separately

The Board registers three divisions — **diagnostic radiographer**, **radiation therapist** and **nuclear medicine technologist**. These are distinct registrations with distinct education pathways; you register in the division your qualification and training support. This guide is for the **diagnostic radiographer** division.

Registration is national; radiation licensing is state-based

MRPBA registration applies Australia-wide. Separately, **using radiation** is licensed at the state or territory level, so you may also need a radiation-use licence in the jurisdiction where you'll work. Your employer will usually guide you through the local licence.

Start here — "Is my qualification recognised?"

The MRPBA publishes an "Is my qualification recognised?" tool and an international-qualifications pathway on its website. It's the right first stop to see where you stand — we can point you to it.

Is my qualification recognised?

Your pathway depends first on whether the Board already recognises your qualification. For some applicants it does — which is the quickest route of all. For everyone else, the Board assesses your qualification portfolio and reaches one of three defined outcomes.

The fast lane — comparable regulators

The Board recognises certain overseas regulators as **comparable** for the diagnostic radiographer division. If your qualification was accredited by a comparable regulator within the listed date range, the Board considers it **substantially equivalent** and you are qualified for general registration — generally without a portfolio assessment or the National exam. This currently includes qualifications approved by the **UK's HCPC** and **Ireland's CORU** within the Board's published date ranges. There is also a list of specific recognised qualifications by institution and award year. Your qualification must **exactly match** the listed division, institution, title and award year to be recognised.

Check your own position on the Board's **"Is my qualification recognised?"** page:

[medicalradiationpracticeboard.gov.au](https://www.medicalradiationpracticeboard.gov.au) → Registration → Internationally qualified → Is my qualification recognised

If it isn't already recognised — the three outcomes

If your qualification isn't on the recognised lists, you apply for an assessment of your qualification portfolio. The Board assesses it against its published criteria (Section 04) and reaches one of these outcomes:

- **Substantially equivalent or based on similar competencies** (s.53(b) of the National Law) — meets the full set of criteria; the most direct route toward general registration.
- **Relevant to the profession** (s.53(c)) — meets the threshold criteria but not full equivalence; registration is still possible, typically with an additional step such as the National examination.
- **Neither equivalent nor relevant** — the minimum threshold criteria aren't met, so the qualification doesn't currently support registration in the division.

Subject to assessment

Recognition is always subject to the Board's assessment of your individual qualifications and evidence, and the recognised lists and date ranges are reviewed periodically — so confirm your own position against the Board's current page and your assessment outcome.

Assessment of your qualification

If your qualification needs assessing, the Board weighs your whole qualification portfolio against three published criteria. Knowing what they are helps you assemble evidence that answers them directly.

The three assessment criteria

- **1. Professional registration** — that your qualification was recognised by a registration or licensing body for the profession where you trained (and that you met any pre-registration assessment or exam there), or, where there's no such body, that it enabled you to practise.
- **2. Quality assurance & accreditation** — that your programme was externally accredited against published education standards, including contemporary, evidence-based practice and work-integrated (clinical) learning.
- **3. Educational level** — that the academic level of your qualification is comparable, at a minimum, to an Australian **Bachelor degree (AQF level 7)**.

Meeting the full set points toward "substantially equivalent"; meeting the threshold criteria points toward "relevant to the profession" (see Section 03).

The core topics the Board looks for

Across all divisions the Board expects coverage of anatomy, physiology and pathology; principles of patient care; clear communication; medical radiation physics; safe radiation practice; CT imaging; and the safe use of medicines including contrast media. For the **diagnostic radiographer** division specifically, it also looks for **projection radiography** and **fluoroscopy** examinations.

Ethicare Insight

It's easy to assume registration is just paperwork. It isn't — it's a real assessment of whether your training meets the Australian standard. The good news is that the part you control most is the part that matters most: start early, and send complete, well-organised documents (certified transcripts, syllabus, clinical-placement evidence). That alone heads off most delays.

The National MRP examination

The National examination is unfamiliar to many overseas candidates, so it's worth understanding clearly — including the fact that not everyone has to sit it.

Why it exists

The National examination for medical radiation practice exists to confirm that practitioners whose qualifications aren't assessed as substantially equivalent still meet the Australian standard of competence before registration. It protects patients and gives employers confidence in a consistent national benchmark.

Who may need to sit it

Whether you sit the exam **depends on your qualification and the outcome of your assessment**. Applicants whose qualifications are already recognised as substantially equivalent — including those accredited by a comparable regulator such as the UK's HCPC or Ireland's CORU within the Board's date ranges — generally are not required to sit it. Where a qualification is assessed as "relevant to the profession" rather than fully equivalent, the exam is commonly required to confirm competence. Not every overseas practitioner follows exactly the same pathway — so treat the exam as a possible step, confirmed by your assessment, rather than an automatic one.

What it involves

Where required, the National examination is a written, knowledge-based assessment. It commonly includes a component covering practice that is common across the divisions and a component specific to your division, and it covers Australian-context material — including radiation safety, professional capabilities and culturally safe practice — alongside the clinical knowledge you'll already recognise.

Confirm the current format

Exam structure, components and pass requirements are set by the Board and reviewed periodically. Always check the current format and rules on the Board's National exam pages before you prepare — we can point you to them.

English language requirements

English-language evidence exists for one reason: safe, precise communication with patients and colleagues. The Board sets this out in a dedicated registration standard.

The English Language Skills Registration Standard

All applicants must satisfy the MRPBA's **English Language Skills Registration Standard**. The standard sets out the recognised ways to demonstrate your English — which may include an approved test result, or one of several exemption pathways (for example, where your education was conducted and assessed in English in a recognised country).

Confirm against the current standard

We've deliberately not reproduced specific test scores or exemption criteria here, because the Board reviews the standard periodically and the accepted tests and pathways can change. Check the current English Language Skills Registration Standard for the exact requirements that apply to you before you book any test — we're happy to point you to it.

Common mistake — testing too early

If you do need a test, time it so the result is still valid when your application reaches the Board. Sitting it too early risks the result expiring before you submit.

Your supporting documents

A clean, complete documentation pack is the single biggest factor within your control on timing. Here's what you'll generally be assembling.

Passport & proof of identity

Certified, with evidence of any name change.

Degree certificate

Your qualifying award in diagnostic radiography / medical imaging.

Academic transcript

Full record of subjects, results and the grading system.

Clinical placement evidence

Evidence of supervised clinical training, where required.

Registration history

Your professional registration / licensure record.

Certificate of Good Standing

From each authority you're registered with, current.

Employment history & CV

Roles, dates and responsibilities, up to date.

English language evidence

If required under the registration standard.

Present it like a professional portfolio

Certified copies (not copies of certified copies), clean high-resolution scans, consistent naming, pages complete and straight. A well-organised application is assessed faster than a disorganised one containing exactly the same facts.

Before you apply

Before diving into the detail, here's your immediate action list. Running through these five steps first is the simplest way to start on the front foot.

-  **Check recognition**
See whether your qualification is already recognised by the Board (Section 03) — it may be the fast lane.
-  **Understand your pathway**
Recognised, portfolio assessment, and whether the National exam is likely to apply to you.
-  **Gather your documents**
Identity, degree, transcript, clinical evidence, registration history, good standing, CV, English.
-  **Decide your visa route**
Employer-sponsored (482) or skilled migration — this determines whether an ASMIRT assessment applies.
-  **Speak to Ethicare**
We'll confirm your pathway, help secure the role and sponsorship, and review your evidence before you submit.

The employer-sponsored (482) pathway

Most candidates Ethicare supports relocate under an employer-sponsored visa. Here's how registration and migration fit together on that pathway — and why the order matters.

Registration is the priority

On the employer-sponsored **Subclass 482** pathway, **MRPBA registration is the priority** — it's what allows you to practise once you arrive. Your employer sponsors the role; the Board registers the practitioner. Both need to happen, but they're separate workstreams.

Is ASMIRT required?

For the 482 pathway, an **ASMIRT migration skills assessment is not generally required simply to obtain professional registration**. ASMIRT's assessment is a migration step tied to particular visa pathways — most often the points-tested skilled-migration visas (such as 189, 190 and 491) — rather than to MRPBA registration itself.

That said, this isn't a blanket "ASMIRT is never required." Additional migration assessments **may** be needed if you later pursue permanent skilled migration or a different visa pathway. Visa requirements depend on the migration route, so always confirm what applies to you with your employer or a registered migration adviser.

Applying through an employer-sponsored visa (Subclass 482)

In short: prioritise MRPBA registration; don't assume you need an ASMIRT assessment just to register; and confirm your specific visa requirements with your employer or migration adviser, since they depend on your chosen pathway.

Applying & what happens next

With your qualification recognition understood and documents assembled, the application itself is methodical. Here's the sequence.

1

Determine your eligibility

Use the Board's "Is my qualification recognised?" pathway to understand your likely route.

2

Prepare your documents

Identity, qualification, transcript, clinical evidence, registration history, good standing, CV, English.

3

Submit your application to Ahpra / MRPBA

Apply for registration in the diagnostic radiographer division, with the (non-refundable) fee.

4

Qualification & English assessment

The Board assesses your qualification; you satisfy the English standard if it applies to you.

5

National examination (if required)

Where your assessment outcome requires it, you sit and pass the National exam.

6

Registration granted

Once registered (and any radiation-use licence is in place), you're cleared to practise.

7

Secure your role & start work

Many Australian employers expect registration to be in place first — with it confirmed, you're ready to take up the role.

How long it takes & fees

Processing times

Processing times vary depending on the completeness of your application, verification of your documents and your individual circumstances. The single biggest factor within your control is a complete, well-evidenced submission — and starting the slowest items (certificates of good standing, document verification) early.

Always check the current fees

We've deliberately not printed fee amounts here. Ahpra and the Board set registration fees, and separate fees apply to the National exam and to state radiation-use licences; all are reviewed periodically. Confirm the current figures on the Board's official fees pages before you budget or pay — we're happy to point you to them.

A note on sequencing

We recommend you don't make irreversible decisions — such as resigning or relocating — until your registration eligibility has been assessed and confirmed. Sponsored candidates should coordinate registration and visa timelines with their employer.

Your registration journey

From first decision to first day at work — the whole journey on a single page. Keep it nearby; it's the map you'll return to throughout.

Determine eligibility ("Is my qualification recognised?")



Prepare registration documents



Submit application to Ahpra / MRPBA



Qualification assessment



English language assessment (if required)



National MRP examination (if required)



Registration granted



Radiation-use licence (state)



Secure your role → commence practice

Common mistakes to avoid

Almost every avoidable delay we see traces back to one of the issues below. Read this as a pre-flight checklist.

⚠ Confusing registration with migration

Assuming ASMIRT is the first step. For practice, MRPBA registration is the one you need.

⚠ Assuming ASMIRT is always required

On a 482 it generally isn't for registration — but it can be for other visa pathways. Confirm yours.

⚠ Thin qualification evidence

Missing transcript or clinical-training detail, so the Board can't judge equivalence.

⚠ Assuming you must sit the exam

Whether the National exam applies depends on your assessment outcome — don't assume either way.

⚠ English evidence too early or wrong test

Check the current registration standard before booking; time it so it stays valid.

⚠ Irreversible decisions too soon

Resigning or relocating before your registration eligibility is confirmed.

✓ The fix for all of these

Understand the two processes, get your qualification assessed early, prepare complete documents, and confirm your visa route with your employer.

Frequently asked questions

Do I need an ASMIRT assessment to register?

Not generally. The MRPBA assesses your qualification for registration. ASMIRT conducts skills assessments for **migration** purposes, which are tied to certain visa pathways. On an employer-sponsored 482, an ASMIRT assessment isn't generally required just to register — but it may be needed for other migration routes.

So who actually assesses my qualification?

For registration, the **MRPBA** does, through Ahpra. That assessment is what determines your pathway to registration and whether you need to sit the National exam.

Will I have to sit the National examination?

It depends on your qualification and the outcome of the Board's assessment. Some applicants are required to; others aren't. Don't assume either way — your assessment confirms it.

What English evidence do I need?

You must satisfy the Board's English Language Skills Registration Standard. The accepted tests and exemption pathways are set in that standard and reviewed periodically, so confirm the current requirements before booking anything.

Frequently asked questions

How long does registration take?

It varies with the completeness of your application, document verification and your circumstances. A complete, well-evidenced submission is the best way to keep things moving.

Is registration the same as a radiation licence?

No. MRPBA registration is national and lets you practise; using radiation is licensed separately by each state or territory. You may need both — your employer will usually help with the local licence.

Can I start applying for jobs before I'm registered?

You can start the conversation early — and many recruiters and employers will support you through the process. That said, a lot of Australian employers expect your registration to be in place (or well underway) before they finalise a role, so it's wise to get your MRPBA application moving first. We help line the two up so they don't hold each other up.

Can Ethicare help with all of this?

Yes. We help secure the role and sponsorship, and we guide you through preparing and timing your registration — flagging issues while they're still easy to fix. The registration decision always rests with the Board.

HOW ETHICARE WILL SUPPORT YOU

You don't have to navigate this alone

If you choose to partner with Ethicare, we'll support you from first enquiry through securing your role and sponsorship, registration and relocation to your first day at work — with a single point of contact, honest guidance, and help at every stage. We support and guide you through the process; the registration decision always rests with the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia.

READY TO BEGIN?

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